Bodo Cultural Heritage: Noh

Category: ARCHITECTURE | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

The Kacháris (Sidney Endle, 1911); Bodoland Tourism

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

Noh refers to the traditional architectural homestead of the Bodo people. A classic Bodo village homestead is built around an open, clean central courtyard called the Sithla. The compound comprises three or four separate thatched cottages with walls of plastered split bamboo or reed (ekra): the main family living quarters (Noh Gudi), a separate kitchen and dining house, a guest room, a granary for unhusked paddy (Bakri), and a livestock shed placed at a hygienic distance. Each homestead is typically surrounded by a ditch and a living reed or bamboo fence to keep domestic livestock safe. The sacred north-eastern corner of the courtyard is always reserved for the Bathou shrine and the holy Sijou altar.